

Psalms 100

Make a Joyful Noise

Make a joyful noise unto the Lord, all ye lands... know ye that the Lord he is God

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Make a joyful noise unto the LORD, all ye lands.*
- 2 *Serve the LORD with gladness: come before his presence with singing.*
- 3 *Know ye that the LORD he is God: it is he that hath made us, and not we ourselves; we are his people, and the sheep of his pasture.*
- 4 *Enter into his gates with thanksgiving, and into his courts with praise: be thankful unto him, and bless his name.*
- 5 *For the LORD is good; his mercy is everlasting; and his truth endureth to all generations.*

2 · CONTEXT

A brief, exuberant call to worship addressed to 'all lands,' not Israel alone, grounding joyful praise in a simple but foundational claim: the Lord is God, He made us, and we belong to Him as His own people and flock. Henry treats its brevity as part of its power—five verses that move from summons, to identity, to grateful entry into worship, without a wasted word.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

The call to worship opens with universal scope—all lands, not Israel only—and specific posture: serve the Lord with gladness, come before His presence with singing. Joy and reverence are named together, not as competing options.

Verse 3

The psalm's theological center is stated as something to know, not merely feel: the Lord is God, He made us and we did not make ourselves, and we are His people, the sheep of His pasture. Identity and origin are settled facts meant to ground worship, not open questions.

Verse 4-5

Worship is pictured as active entry: come into His gates with thanksgiving, into His courts with praise, be thankful, bless His name. The reason given is God's own character—good, with mercy that endures forever and truth that reaches to all generations—stability spanning both the immediate moment and every generation to come.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Genuine worship rests on settled knowledge, not fluctuating feeling: the Lord is God, He made us, and we belong to Him—facts that remain true regardless of mood, making joyful, thankful entry into His presence appropriate at all times, not only when it feels natural.

Application for life today.

When gladness in worship feels forced or distant, return to verse 3's settled facts—God is God, He made you, you belong to Him—and let thanksgiving follow deliberate knowledge rather than waiting for spontaneous feeling. Practice 'coming into His gates with thanksgiving' (v. 4) as an actual entry point into prayer or worship, naming specific things you are grateful for before moving to requests. Let the psalm's global address ('all ye lands') remind you that this same worship is due from every people, not a private comfort reserved for the already convinced.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. How does grounding worship in the settled fact 'the Lord he is God' (v. 3), rather than in current feeling, change how you approach a flat or distracted day of prayer?

2. What would it look like to deliberately 'come into his gates with thanksgiving' (v. 4) as a specific first step in prayer, rather than starting with requests?

3. How does the psalm's address to 'all ye lands' (v. 1) shape how you think about worship's reach beyond your own circle of faith?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).